

Chapter 100-3

The woman sneered coldly. "How interesting. I could make a phone call right here and say I'm calling the mayor to have all of you arrested. Do you think I'm an idiot?! Acting like big shots in front of me, damn it, I..."

Before the woman could finish speaking, her phone rang.

She frowned. "Excuse me, ma'am. After the doctor's examination, Xu Tong is no longer in any serious condition. Please come downstairs now to process the discharge paperwork."

The woman froze for a few seconds, then said in surprise, "Aren't you about to get off work?!"

The other party replied, "Once we finish processing yours, we can get off work. Please come downstairs as soon as possible."

The woman was dumbfounded. After she hung up the phone, her lips moved slightly, muttering something unintelligible under her breath.

Liang Xinzhou stood before her and said coldly, "You still have a chance now."

The woman looked up at him, then suddenly shouted angrily, "Just because you rich people have money, you think you can treat human lives like grass?! Your daughter pushed my son, he developed a high fever last night and still hasn't recovered, and now you want to force my son to be discharged! If anything happens to my son, will you take responsibility?!"

She stood in the hospital corridor, eyes red as she berated Liang Xinzhou. "You're so rich, what's wrong with compensating my son for his medical expenses?! Why do you keep coming here again and again—what do you want?! Do you want me to die?! Would you only admit your child was wrong if I died?! Huh?!"

That last syllable was shrieked until her voice cracked. The woman's mournful voice echoed through the corridor, and everyone couldn't help but poke their heads out to watch the commotion.

Ling Dang hid behind Liang Xinzhou, holding Liang Shi's hand.

After hearing the woman's words, she couldn't help but shrink back. Her eyes, which had just started to recover a little, turned red again, and she shed tears of grievance and fear.

Ling Dang let go of Liang Shi's hand and stepped forward to tug at Liang Xinzhou.

Liang Xinzhou looked down and saw Ling Dang shaking her head at him, choking out in a low voice, "Uncle, let's go. I don't want you to do this anymore. Let's just go..."

Liang Xinzhou patted her hand, crouched down, and wiped away her tears. "Ling Dang, you just need to tell me—did you do it or not?"

Ling Dang shook her head and cried, "I didn't do it, but I don't want you to be scolded by others..."

"It's okay." Liang Xinzhou said, "If our Ling Dang didn't do it, then no one is allowed to wrongly accuse you."

Liang Shi stood there, and suddenly a tear fell.

It dropped directly onto the ground, with residual droplets hanging on her eyelashes.

Someone in front of her suddenly handed her a tissue. It was a very beautiful hand with neatly trimmed nails, slender fingers worthy of the phrase "fingers like white scallion stalks,"¹ but somewhat overly thin.

Liang Shi turned to look and found it was Shen Hui.

She sniffled, only then realizing she had lost her composure.

She took the tissue from Shen Hui's hand and thanked her quietly. She wanted to go comfort Ling Dang, but Liang Xinzhou was already leading Ling Dang toward the woman.

The woman had become somewhat hysterical from her emotional breakdown, constantly mumbling something under her breath. When she saw Liang Xinzhou walking over, her pupils shook, then she widened her eyes. "Don't come over here! Do you want me to die?! You rich people just want to force us to death! Fine, I'll go die! Even if I die, I won't let you off!"

As she spoke, she was about to slam herself into the wall, but Liang Xinzhou grabbed her and then threw her directly onto the ground.

Liang Xinzhou looked down at her from above and said coldly, "Being rich is nothing special, and I don't want to force you to death."

The woman sat on the ground, tears streaming down her face.

Liang Xinzhou didn't soften because of this. "The children raised by our family don't lie, so when my niece says she didn't do it, she didn't do it. Our family has money—a lot of money. We can pay for your son's treatment, even cover all his medical expenses, but we won't accept your extortion."

"I'm going to expose you online! Not letting poor people see doctors!" the woman shouted, struggling to get up. "You rich people just want to force poor people to death!"

"Then do as you please." Liang Xinzhou said, "I've checked the supermarket surveillance and your son's past medical records. You and your husband have been going to that supermarket every night this week. Normally you never leave your son's side, so why is it that the night before last, neither of you was near your son? Your son has a chronic illness, right? Your husband lost his job last month, causing your family to default on your mortgage payments. Your company had layoffs two months ago. You can no longer afford your son's medical expenses, so you thought of extortion as a solution, right?"

Liang Xinzhou's sharp gaze fell on her. "If you had sought donations through proper channels, I would have donated money for your son's medical expenses and living costs. But framing our family's child—that's not acceptable."

When Liang Xinzhou said those last two words, he bit down hard on them, as if saying—this is my final bottom line.

The woman sat on the ground in utter despair, her gaze vacant. Liang Xinzhou took out his phone and showed her a photo of Guo Xinran. "Do you know this person?"

The woman didn't speak.

Liang Xinzhou said, "If you cooperate with me, I'll help pay for your son's medical expenses and let your son continue staying at this hospital."

The woman's eyes lit up. Liang Xinzhou asked her, "Do you know her?"

The woman said, "Isn't that the little..."

The curse words were already on the tip of her tongue, but she swallowed them back out of fear.

"She's your niece's aunt," the woman said. "Your younger sister. Why are you asking me?"

"I mean, did you ever see her before this incident happened?" Liang Xinzhou asked.

The woman answered frankly, "Definitely not. That day was the first time we saw your family's child."

At this point, the woman also asked, "If I tell the truth, you'll pay for the medical expenses, right?"

Liang Xinzhou nodded. "Yes."

Only then did the woman feel reassured. But when she was about to speak, she held back a bit. "Give me two hundred... no, five hundred thousand."

"Fine." Liang Xinzhou said.

After speaking, he smoothly turned on the recording function on his phone.

The woman then poured out their entire plan without reservation.

They had been scouting the supermarket every day, observing the surveillance blind spots. That day, they actually hadn't planned to extort anyone—they just wanted to simply take the child to buy some vegetables. But they noticed that the clothes Guo Xinran was wearing were very expensive, so they determined this was a wealthy family and let their son wander around unsupervised.

They hadn't expected everything to go so smoothly.

If... these people hadn't investigated.

After the woman finished speaking, she even wiped away a tear. "That woman was so rich and had such a weak personality. Who knew your whole family would be so formidable? If I had known earlier, I wouldn't have done this."

Liang Xinzhou saved the recording. "So you hadn't met that girl before this incident?"

The woman shook her head. "No."

Liang Xinzhou had gotten the information he wanted. "Alright, that's it then."

"What about the five hundred thousand?" The woman was shocked and grabbed his sleeve. "Where's my money?"

Liang Xinzhou turned to look at her and revealed a cold smile. "Money only becomes yours when it's deposited into your account."

"You promised to give me money!" the woman said.

Liang Xinzhou countered, "Where's your evidence?"

The woman: "....."

She was about to wail again when Liang Xinzhou said coldly, "I have no intention of helping someone who deliberately schemed against my niece. I've already saved this recording, and I will hire a lawyer to sue you for fraud. You can take your child home now and wait for the court summons."

The woman was completely stunned.

Liang Xinzhou's tactics had all been honed in the business world. This woman was no match for him at all.

First coercion, then enticement—give a slap, then offer a date.²

A classic capitalist maneuver.

Liang Shi stood in the back, watching in amazement.

Just as Liang Xinzhou was about to lead Ling Dang away, a child suddenly walked out from the hospital room. He walked unsteadily with toddling steps and called out in a clear voice, "Mommy~"

Liang Xinzhou turned around and saw the little boy running toward the woman, then breaking into an adorable smile, complete with little dimples.

He wiped the woman's tears. "Mommy, why are you crying?"

The woman was completely different from her earlier hysterical appearance, screaming that she wanted to die. Instead, her entire being now radiated a gentle glow, and she forced out a smile. "Mommy is fine."

Liang Xinzhou paused at the sight, then said, "I won't give you the money, but I will pay for your son's treatment."

1. "Fingers like white scallion stalks" (指如蔥白): A classical Chinese expression used to describe beautiful, slender, pale fingers. It comes from ancient poetry and is commonly used to describe elegant feminine hands. ⇐
2. "Give a slap, then offer a date" (打個巴掌給顆棗): A Chinese idiom describing a manipulation tactic where someone first intimidates or punishes, then offers something positive. Similar to "good cop, bad cop" or "carrot and stick" in English. The "date" refers to a Chinese red date (jujube), which is a small sweet fruit. ⇐